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corporate sector, have not been touched or have not been attempted to be revitalised or incentivised. Complete focus is on consumer spending, not just by the urban or the higher income classes but it is very wide based, what you call inclusive growth.

Bibek Debroy: The question is wrong in the sense that this Budget does not believe in a big idea. There is a continuity with what the Congress thought to be important under the UPA. Under the first UPA, the Congress perceives, rightly or wrongly, that it has got electoral dividends. But, if one expected a big-bang reform, it isn't there. All that the Budget has given is that expenditure was going to happen. All that it has is: it sort of asks can we clean up the taxes, can we rationalise/harmonise them. This is the first budget since 1999-2000 that actually attempts to do so.

Suman K. Bery: Even though this gentleman was the finance minister for the interim budget, this is a part-year Budget under difficult times. So, I was trying to understand both its political strategy and its economic strategy and the intertwining of the two. Whether it is the question of the

Maharashtra state elections or not, there was certainly a lot there that tells about West Bengal politics. On the economics front, it was a statement of direction by a Government that believes it will last a full term in Parliament. It would have been easy for him to bemoan globalisation, how unfair the rest of the world is. But those are not the signs we get to see. So, it as an affirmation of the fact that India gains from globalisation and a liberal economic order. They have accepted that in this uncertain moment of global economy, the horse you need to back is consumption.

Mahendra Dev: What this Government is doing for inclusive growth is reflected in the Budget. Given the problems at the global level, what is needed is increase in domestic demand. It has given the stimulus needed for infrastructure and the rural sector, which will increase demand and consumption. It will also increase private consumption. Even at the expense of the fiscal deficit, there is the fiscal stimulus in the short run and that is the whole idea about this Budget, though it is in continuity. The big bang has already come via the Economic Survey. Many people are criticising because there is no

Private consumption declined from 53.8% in '07-08 to 27% in '08-09. Government consumption rose from 8% to 32.5%.